



Structured Administration & Supply Arrangement (SASA)

Aperient

Docusate 50 mg Senna/Sennosides 8 mg

(Nurse Initiated Medicine)

Issuing Authority

Health Service	Sir Charles Gairdner Osborne Park Health Care Group (SCGOPHCG)
Address	Hospital Avenue, Nedlands, Western Australia
Contact	6457 2348

Authorisations

Practitioners:	SCGOPHCG Registered Nurse SCGOPHCG Medication Competent Enrolled Nurse
Practice Setting:	Inpatient
Qualification:	Registered with the Nursing & Midwifery Board of Australia Enrolled Nurse who has completed a Board-approved qualification in administration of medicines
Authorisation:	Initiation and administration
Risk rating:	Low
Patients	Eligible inpatients as outlined within inclusion criteria

Approved Sites

Site	Site Address
1.	Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital, Hospital Avenue, Nedlands, WA
2.	Osborne Park Hospital, Osborne Place, Stirling, WA

Docusate 50 mg Senna/Sennosides 8 mg

Route:	Oral	Brand:	Coloxyl with Senna®, Co-Senna® or any other stocked brand
Form:	Tablet	Strength:	Docusate sodium 50 mg; Senna/sennosides 8 mg
Dose:	Adult: 50/8 mg – 100/16 mg	Quantity:	Maximum of 2 consecutive doses
Instructions:	Adult: Take 1 to 2 tablets (50/8 mg – 100/16 mg) once or twice daily when required. Maximum of 4 tablets daily in divided doses. <i>If the medicine is to continue after a maximum of two doses or greater than 24 hours, it must be prescribed by a medical officer, nurse practitioner or another authorised prescriber.</i>		
Administration Notes:	Can be taken with or without food. Take tablets with plenty of fluid. Onset of action expected within 6-12 hours.		
Patient Inclusion:	Patients experiencing or at risk of constipation.		
Patient Exclusion:	Known documented allergy to the active substance or to any of the excipients. Intestinal obstruction, partial or complete. Acute abdominal conditions, e.g. appendicitis. Inflammatory bowel conditions. Severe nausea/vomiting/abdominal cramps/abdominal pain of unknown cause. Diarrhoea. Undiagnosed rectal bleeding. Concomitant use of liquid paraffin. Anorexia Nervosa.		
Safety in Pregnancy/ Breastfeeding:	Pregnancy: avoid except for occasional doses. Breastfeeding: safe to use.		
Documentation:	All nurse-initiated medication MUST be legibly documented on the 'Once only, Pre-medication and Nurse Initiated medicines' section of the WA Hospital Short Stay Medication Chart (WA HMC) SCGH		

	MR410/805 and OPH MR170.1, Long-Stay Medication Chart SCGH MR401/805 and OPH MR170.2 or Pre/post-Operative Protocol for Day Surgery Patients MR730.5 and comply with all legal requirements.
Adverse Effects:	Docusate: Abdominal cramps, diarrhoea, nausea, rash. Senna: discolouration of urine (yellowish brown or red).
Clinical Guidelines	

Related policies, procedures, and guidelines

SCGOPHCG Guidelines

- SCGOPHCG: [Medication Management – Nurse Initiated Medicines](#)
- SCGOPHCG: [Medicines Management](#)

References

1. Australian Medicines Handbook. [Internet]. Adelaide (South Australia): Australian Medicines Handbook; 2024 [cited 2024 May 8] Available from: [Australian Medicines Handbook \(health.wa.gov.au\)](https://www.austlii.edu.au/au/other/australianmedicineshandbook/)
2. Structured Administration and Supply Arrangements, Department of Health. Available at https://ww2.health.wa.gov.au/Articles/S_T/Structured-Administration-and-Supply-Arrangements
3. [SCGOPHCG Structured Administration and Supply Arrangements \(SASAs\)](#)
4. Fact sheet: Docusate with Senna [Internet]. Nedlands (WA): WA Medicine Information Leaflet (WA MIL), Department of Health (WA); 2018 [updated 2020 May; cited 2024 May 8]. Available from: [Medicine Information Leaflets \(health.wa.gov.au\)](#)
5. Pregnancy and Breastfeeding Medicines Guide [Internet]. Melbourne (VIC): The Royal Women's Hospital; Senna [cited 2024 Sept 05]. Available from: [senna | PBMG \(thewomenspbmg.org.au\)](#)

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Committee	Medicines and Therapeutics Committee		
Chairperson	Deepan Krishnasivam	Endorsed	11/11/2024
Nursing			
Name	Annie Thompson	Signed:	
Position	Area Director of Nursing	Date:	19/11/2024
Senior Medical Practitioner			
Name	Deepan Krishnasivam	Signed:	
Position	Deputy Director of Clinical Services	Date:	19/11/2024
Executive			
Name	Jodi Graham	Signed:	
Position	Executive Director	Date:	20/11/2024
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Owner:	Chief Pharmacist		
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